



A Warning About Democratic Socialism in House District 27

A practical guide to why Mark believes Oregon House District 27 needs opportunity, accountability, public safety, economic growth, and individual freedom, not a socialist candidate who supports larger government and centralized control.

Mark Norman

OREGON HOUSE DISTRICT 27 • REPUBLICAN • 2026

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Why Mark Norman opposes **democratic socialism**.

I do not support socialism, and I do not support democratic socialism.

Oregon's future should not be placed in the hands of a larger-government agenda built around higher taxes, expanded bureaucracy, public ownership, wealth redistribution, and centralized control. That direction is wrong for Oregon, and it is wrong for House District 27.

Socialism is not just a label. It is a political and economic philosophy that gives government a much larger role in directing the economy, regulating private enterprise, redistributing income, expanding public programs, and making families and businesses more dependent on government systems.

I believe government has important responsibilities. It should protect public safety, maintain infrastructure, educate students, help vulnerable people, and provide fair rules. But government should not control the economy, punish success, weaken small businesses, replace local decision-making, or make working families more dependent on bureaucracy.

My concern is simple: once government becomes larger, more expensive, and more controlling, it becomes much harder to reverse. Higher taxes, more mandates, and more bureaucracy do not create prosperity. They make Oregon less affordable, less competitive, and less free.

Oregon needs a different direction. We should support private enterprise, small businesses, personal responsibility, local decision-making, strong communities, and policies that help people become more independent, not more dependent on government.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregon does not need socialism. Oregon needs affordability, accountability, opportunity, and common sense.

Voters should know about the **DSA** agenda.

The **Democratic Socialists of America** is not just a casual political label, and voters should not treat it like one.

DSA is a national socialist organization built around a political agenda that would give government a much larger role in health care, housing, labor policy, taxation, transportation, energy, public safety, and major parts of the economy. This is not simply a normal debate about whether to spend a little more or a little less on schools, health care, or housing. It is a much bigger debate about who should have the power to shape our communities: families, workers, small businesses, private citizens, local communities, and accountable institutions, or centralized government systems operating under a socialist political agenda.

Our local DSA is not separate from that national agenda. Portland DSA identifies itself as a chapter of the Democratic Socialists of America and openly shares the same socialist vision of moving beyond capitalism. Its priorities are directly aligned with the national DSA platform: higher taxes, expanded government programs, rent control, government-run health care, public transit expansion, anti-capitalist politics, and more centralized control over economic life.

I reject the DSA approach because it moves Oregon in the wrong direction. Oregon cannot tax, regulate, bureaucratize, and centralize its way into prosperity. We have already seen what happens when government keeps growing while families, homeowners, renters, and small businesses are asked to pay more and more.

“Tax the rich” may sound simple, but in practice the definition of “rich” keeps expanding. In a high-cost state like Oregon, it can quickly reach small business owners, homeowners, professionals, and families who worked hard, saved, bought a home, built a business, or earned a good job. We cannot build a healthy economy by treating success as a problem to be punished.

Instead of expanding government without limit, Oregon needs to control costs, review the unrestrained growth of state and local government, protect taxpayers, support small businesses, and make government accountable to the people, not the other way around.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregon does not need socialism. Oregon needs affordability, accountability, opportunity, and a government that works for citizens instead of demanding more from them every year.

Bigger government is not compassion. It is control.

Supporters of democratic socialism often use language that sounds compassionate: fairness, security, housing, health care, and opportunity. Those concerns are real. Oregon does need reform, accountability, and compassion.

But voters should also understand what comes with the democratic socialist agenda: larger government, higher taxes, expanded bureaucracy, more regulation, public ownership, and more centralized control over major parts of economic life.

I do not believe Oregon needs to replace capitalism, weaken private enterprise, or move major sectors of the economy under government control. Large government-centered systems often create serious unintended consequences: higher taxes and fees, higher energy and utility costs, slower services, fewer choices, less local flexibility, and programs measured by how much money they spend instead of whether they actually work.

Our nation was founded on protected rights and broad liberties. America's success has been built on individual liberty, private property rights, entrepreneurship, free enterprise, strong families, local communities, and the opportunity for people to improve their lives through hard work, personal initiative, and service to others.

Government has an important role. It should protect rights, maintain public safety, educate students, support infrastructure, help vulnerable people, and provide fair rules. But government should serve the people, not control them, punish success, or make families and small businesses more dependent on bureaucracy.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregon needs compassion with accountability, reform with results, and opportunity rooted in freedom, not a larger government system that centralizes power and limits choice.

House District 27 cannot afford a socialist direction.

This issue is not theoretical. Voters in House District 27 deserve to understand the different governing philosophies being presented to them.

This election is not just about personalities. It is about whether our district moves toward more government control, higher taxes, and expanded bureaucracy, or toward practical leadership, public safety, strong schools, economic growth, local accountability, and individual freedom.

I respect the right of others to hold different political beliefs. I also respect public service and civic participation. But voters deserve clarity. When a candidate publicly identifies with a national political organization, voters have a right to ask which parts of that organization's agenda they support and which parts they reject.

That is especially important when the organization's stated platform calls for a much larger role for government in health care, housing, education, labor policy, taxation, climate policy, transportation, energy, and public ownership of major economic sectors.

MY POSITION IS CLEAR

- ★ I support fully funding public safety, recruiting and retaining qualified police officers, holding repeat offenders accountable, and giving law enforcement the tools needed to keep neighborhoods safe.
- ★ I support strong schools focused on academic excellence, reading, math, discipline, civics, and opportunity.
- ★ I support lower costs for working families, a better climate for small businesses, and a government that respects taxpayers.
- ★ I support helping vulnerable Oregonians, but I believe public programs must be accountable, effective, and measured by results, not by how much money they spend.

I trust voters to compare the visions being offered in this race. I believe House District 27 needs practical leadership that protects public safety, restores accountability, supports opportunity, and keeps government working for the people, not the other way around.

Government control vs. Mark Norman's **practical leadership.**

The Socialist Direction I Reject

- ★ Larger government
- ★ Higher taxes and fees
- ★ Expanded bureaucracy
- ★ Government-run systems
- ★ Public ownership of major sectors
- ★ More centralized control
- ★ More mandates from Salem
- ★ Less freedom for families and small businesses
- ★ Programs measured by spending and size
- ★ More pressure on taxpayers and employers

The Direction I Support

- ★ Responsible spending
- ★ Local flexibility
- ★ Small-business growth
- ★ Parent transparency
- ★ Public safety with accountability
- ★ Healthcare choice
- ★ Reliable energy
- ★ Animal welfare with respect for responsible ownership
- ★ Veteran support that delivers real help
- ★ Programs measured by results

I believe Oregon needs service, solutions, and accountability.

Mark Norman's 9 issue priorities.

1. ANIMAL WELFARE

No on IP-28. Animal welfare with common sense, not government overreach.

As a veterinarian with more than 30 years of experience serving Oregon families and their animals, I care deeply about animal welfare. I have seen firsthand the harm caused by cruelty, neglect, lack of access to veterinary care, and uncontrolled pet overpopulation.

I support strong, practical, science-based animal welfare laws. Oregon already has meaningful laws addressing animal cruelty, neglect, and abuse, and those laws should be enforced. I also believe we should improve animal welfare through thoughtful legislation that brings veterinarians, shelters, rescues, farmers, ranchers, hunters, pet owners, and animal welfare advocates to the table.

I oppose IP 28 because it goes far beyond preventing cruelty. Oregon's current laws recognize important distinctions for lawful and humane activities such as hunting, fishing, farming, ranching, food production, veterinary care, wildlife management, and responsible animal husbandry. Those existing protections are not loopholes for abuse; they are necessary legal distinctions that allow Oregonians to care for animals, produce food, manage wildlife, and maintain public health.

My concern with IP 28 is that it is too broad and poorly written. It could create uncertainty for veterinarians, farmers, ranchers, hunters, fishers, researchers, and responsible animal owners while doing little to solve the animal welfare problems.

I support legislation that would help reduce pet overpopulation and increase access to lower-cost spay and neuter services across Oregon. We should make it easier for families, shelters, rescues, and rural communities to access basic veterinary care before problems become crises.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Animal welfare policy should be humane, practical, science-based, and respectful of responsible ownership.

2. DATA CENTERS

Innovation should not come at the expense of **local communities.**

Data centers are increasingly important to technology, artificial intelligence, cloud computing, and Oregon's long-term economic competitiveness. I support innovation, and I believe Oregon should be a place where technology companies can grow, invest, and create opportunity.

But growth must be responsible. Data centers place major demands on electricity, water, land, roads, utilities, and local infrastructure. Oregon cannot simply approve large new energy users without a serious plan for reliable power generation, transmission capacity, water use, land use, and protection for local ratepayers.

My concern is not with data centers themselves. My concern is with poorly planned development that shifts costs onto local families, small businesses, farmers, and communities. Data centers should pay their fair share for the infrastructure they require, and they should not receive special treatment while Oregonians face higher utility bills.

Oregon's need for more reliable energy is clear. We should be honest that future growth, including data centers, artificial intelligence, advanced manufacturing, housing, and electrification, will require more dependable power. That is why I support a serious, science-based review of all reliable energy options, including small modular nuclear reactors. If SMRs can meet appropriate safety, waste, cost, and regulatory standards, Oregon should be willing to consider legislation that allows them to become part of our long-term energy mix.

I also believe state policy should protect high-value farmland and make sure local governments have a real voice in siting decisions. Economic development should not come at the expense of ratepayers, farmers, or communities that are already struggling with rising costs.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregon can support innovation while requiring accountability, reliable energy planning, fair tax treatment, and protection for local communities.

3. EDUCATION

Strong basics. Real skills. Parents in the loop.

Oregon schools should be focused on preparing students for adult life. That starts with reading, writing, math, science, civics, discipline, critical thinking, and career readiness.

Simply pouring more money into the same system, without addressing the root causes of failure, will not fix Oregon's schools. We need to be honest about what is not working: too many students are not reading or doing math at grade level, too many students are chronically absent, and too much education funding is absorbed before it reaches teachers, students, and classrooms.

Class size matters, but Oregon's problem is much deeper than class size. Student enrollment has been declining across the state, while the number of school employees has continued to grow. The question we should be asking is simple: how much of our education funding is actually reaching the classroom and improving student learning?

I believe we need to return to the fundamentals. Every child should be taught to read using evidence-based instruction, including phonics and other proven literacy tools. Students who cannot read well by the end of the early grades face a much harder path in every subject that follows. Reading is not just another school issue; it is the foundation for opportunity.

We also need to take math seriously again. Oregon students deserve clear academic standards, regular measurement of progress, and honest accountability when students are falling behind. Lowering expectations does not help children. It hides failure until it is too late.

I support teachers and believe they should be empowered to teach. That means safe, orderly classrooms, strong curriculum, practical support, and fewer distractions from the core mission of education. Teachers cannot do their best work when state mandates, administrative priorities, and political agendas pull attention away from reading, writing, math, science, and discipline.

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3. EDUCATION • CONTINUED

Students, teachers, and classrooms **come first.**

Parents should be respected as partners in their children's education. Families deserve transparency about curriculum, academic progress, school safety, and major decisions affecting their children. Strong schools require trust, and trust requires openness.

I also support a serious review of how education dollars are being spent. Counselors, nurses, special education staff, bus drivers, and support staff can play important roles, but Oregon must make sure resources are not being swallowed by administrative growth, duplicated programs, or non-classroom priorities that do not improve student achievement. The priority should be students, teachers, and classrooms.

Oregon also needs stronger vocational and career pathways. Not every student will choose a four-year college, and that should never be treated as failure. We should expand opportunities in the trades, technical education, apprenticeships, agriculture, health care, public safety, and other career fields that lead to meaningful work and financial independence.

Local communities need flexibility. What works for a large urban district may not be right for a rural school, a small district, or a career-focused program. The state should set high expectations, measure results honestly, and then give local educators and parents room to meet the needs of their students.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Teachers should be empowered to teach, parents should be respected as partners, and students should graduate with the knowledge, skills, discipline, and confidence they need for adult life.

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4. LOCAL ISSUES OVER IDEOLOGY

Oregon problems need **Oregon solutions.**

Many Oregonians are tired of division, hostility, and ideological purity tests. I believe people of different backgrounds, faiths, viewpoints, and political beliefs should be able to live, work, worship, and raise their families together with respect.

I want to be very clear: I stand with Oregon's Jewish community. Antisemitism is wrong. Period. It has no place in Oregon, not on our campuses, not in our schools, not in our streets, not in our politics, and not in our State Legislature.

I also believe the State of Israel has the absolute right to exist and the absolute right to defend itself and its people. That should not be a controversial position. It is a moral one.

Jewish Oregonians should never feel unsafe, intimidated, marginalized, or targeted because of their faith, identity, or support for Israel. Elected leaders have a responsibility to say so clearly, without hesitation and without political calculation.

At the same time, I believe Oregon's legislature must stay focused on the urgent problems facing our own communities: affordability, schools, public safety, small business, energy costs, transportation, housing, and government accountability. We do not need more division imported into local government. We need serious people willing to solve Oregon problems.

People do not need to agree on every national or international issue to work together on local concerns. But we do need basic moral clarity, mutual respect, and a willingness to stand against hatred when we see it.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregon should be a place where people of every faith and background can live safely and respectfully, and where elected leaders focus on solving real problems rather than fueling division.

5. PUBLIC SAFETY

Compassion and safety **belong together.**

Public safety is one of government's most basic responsibilities. Every Oregonian deserves to feel safe in their home, their neighborhood, their school, their business, and their community.

I support fully funding public safety and making sure our law enforcement agencies have the staffing, training, and tools they need to do their jobs well. That includes improving recruitment and retention, supporting strong professional standards, and strengthening community policing so officers are connected to the communities they serve.

At the same time, we need to be honest about the problems driving much of what Oregonians see every day: addiction, untreated mental illness, homelessness, and repeat offenders cycling through the system without meaningful consequences or meaningful help. Compassion without accountability does not work. Accountability without treatment also falls short.

Oregon needs better coordination between law enforcement, behavioral health providers, addiction treatment, emergency response, shelters, courts, and community organizations. We should not expect police officers to solve every social problem alone, but we also cannot leave neighborhoods, businesses, and families to absorb the consequences of a broken system.

I believe we need stronger responses to repeat criminal behavior, especially when people are threatening public safety, damaging property, or victimizing small businesses and vulnerable residents. At the same time, we should expand access to mental health care, addiction treatment, crisis response, and recovery programs that help people get their lives back on track.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregonians should not have to choose between compassion and safety. We need both.

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6. SMALL BUSINESS

Small businesses need room to grow.

Small businesses are the backbone of Oregon's economy. They create local jobs, support families, sponsor community events, train young workers, and keep our neighborhoods alive.

As someone who helped build and operate a small business in Oregon, I understand what it means to live within a budget, make payroll, manage rising costs, comply with regulations, hire and retain employees, and serve customers every day. I also know what it takes to provide workers with access to health insurance, retirement plans, and other benefits that help families build stable lives.

Small business owners are not abstract numbers on a spreadsheet. They are neighbors, employers, taxpayers, and problem-solvers. They want to take care of their employees, serve their customers, and contribute to their communities, but Oregon has become increasingly difficult and expensive for small businesses to operate.

Too often, the state government treats small employers as endless sources of revenue instead of partners in economic growth. New fees, complicated regulations, slow permitting, higher taxes, and unpredictable mandates make it harder for local businesses to survive, grow, and hire.

I support reducing unnecessary regulations, streamlining permitting, reviewing excessive fees, improving access to capital, and expanding workforce training. I also believe Oregon should protect independent contractors, family businesses, and small employers from one-size-fits-all policies written without understanding how businesses actually operate.

A healthy economy requires more than large corporations and government programs. It requires small businesses that can open their doors, hire employees, invest in their communities, provide good jobs, and grow without being punished for succeeding.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Small businesses should be treated as partners in Oregon's future, not endless sources of revenue.

7. TRANSPORTATION & ENERGY

Infrastructure should be based on reality, not ideology.

Oregon should support transportation and energy policies grounded in affordability, reliability, mobility, and measurable public benefit. The goal should be simple: help people get where they need to go and make sure families, workers, and businesses can afford the energy they depend on.

I support public transportation. Many Oregonians rely on transit to get to work, school, medical appointments, grocery stores, and other essential services. Dependable transportation is especially important for seniors, students, people with disabilities, lower-income workers, and families who cannot easily rely on a car for every trip.

But we also need to be honest about what has changed. Downtown Portland is no longer the single hub of business and employment that it once was. More people work from home, more jobs are located in the suburbs, and more families need flexible transportation options that match where people actually live and work.

That is why I believe major transportation projects should be judged by actual rider behavior, cost, safety, reliability, fare collection, and long-term sustainability. Light rail may have a role in some corridors, but it is expensive, slow to build, difficult to reroute, and costly to operate. When ridership is down and costs are rising, Oregon should not keep doubling down on the same model without asking hard questions.

Buses are often a more flexible and practical solution. They can be added, reduced, redirected, or rerouted as workforce patterns, housing, schools, and business needs change. A strong bus system can serve neighborhoods, suburbs, job centers, and communities that fixed rail may never reach efficiently.

Safety and fare accountability also matter. People are less likely to use public transit if they do not feel safe, and public systems lose trust when fare collection and basic order are treated as low priorities. Riders, taxpayers, and transit workers all deserve a system that is safe, clean, reliable, and financially responsible.

7. TRANSPORTATION & ENERGY • CONTINUED

Affordable, reliable, and abundant power.

Oregon should invest in infrastructure people actually use: roads, bridges, buses, freight corridors, safe streets, and transportation systems that reflect how people live now, not how planners imagined they would live decades ago.

Energy policy should follow the same principle. Oregon needs affordable, reliable, and abundant power. I support an all-of-the-above energy strategy that includes hydroelectric power, natural gas, renewables, improved transmission, storage, and serious investigation of next-generation nuclear power, including small modular reactors where science, safety, cost, and regulation support it.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Oregon should invest in transportation and energy systems that are affordable, reliable, safe, flexible, and accountable to the people who actually use and pay for them.

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8. HEALTHCARE

Healthcare should be patient-centered, **not** bureaucracy-centered.

Health care costs are too high, insurance bureaucracy is frustrating, and too many Oregon families delay care because they are worried about affordability. Those are real problems, and they deserve serious solutions.

But simply turning more control over to government will not automatically mean better care, lower costs, or faster access. More bureaucracy is not the same thing as more doctors, more nurses, more appointments, more mental health providers, or more treatment beds.

I do not support a government-run single-payer health care system for Oregon. The recent loss or movement of some insurance providers does not mean private insurance is finished in Oregon. There is still meaningful private insurance capacity in our state, and every county continues to have multiple coverage options available.

We should also learn from other places. Vermont tried to move toward a state-level single-payer system and ultimately backed away after the costs and economic disruption became clear. Canada's single-payer system provides universal coverage, but it also shows the risk of long waits, limited specialist access, and delays in treatment. Oregon should not ignore those warnings.

Instead of replacing one frustrating system with an even larger government-run bureaucracy, I support practical reforms that improve affordability, access, transparency, and patient choice. Patients should be able to understand what care costs, compare options, keep access to the providers they trust, and receive timely care.

We also need to support the people who deliver care. Oregon should make it easier to recruit and retain doctors, nurses, mental health professionals, addiction counselors, dentists, pharmacists, and community health providers, especially in rural and underserved areas.

Mental health and addiction treatment must be part of any serious health care plan. Too many families are struggling to find timely help, and too many communities are seeing the consequences when treatment is unavailable or delayed.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Health care reform should lower costs, improve access, increase transparency, and protect patient choice, not centralize decisions through expanding government control.

9. VETERAN SUPPORT

Veterans deserve dignity, respect, and real support.

As a retired Navy veteran, I understand that service leaves a lasting impact long after the uniform comes off. The oath does not end when military service ends, and neither should our commitment to the men and women who served.

Veterans fulfilled their commitment to this country. Government and society should fulfill their commitment to them. That means real access to health care, mental health services, addiction treatment, housing assistance, workforce training, career transition support, and employment opportunities for veterans and military families.

Too many veterans are forced to navigate layers of bureaucracy when they need timely, practical help. Too many struggle with invisible wounds, unstable housing, delayed care, or difficulty transitioning into civilian employment. Empty promises and complicated systems are not enough.

I believe Oregon should work more effectively with local veteran organizations, county veteran service officers, nonprofits, employers, health care providers, and community colleges to connect veterans with the services they have earned. Help should be easier to find, easier to use, and focused on results.

Veterans are not asking for special treatment. They are asking for the country they served to keep faith with them and their families.

MY POSITION IS SIMPLE

Veterans deserve real help, not empty promises buried in bureaucracy.



Help push back against democratic socialism in Oregon.

If you believe House District 27 needs opportunity, accountability, public safety, strong schools, economic growth, individual freedom, and practical leadership instead of democratic socialism, there is room for you to help.

There are many ways to participate depending on your time, schedule, and comfort level.

WAYS TO GET INVOLVED

- ★ Share this guide
- ★ Sign up for campaign updates
- ★ Ask Mark a question
- ★ Attend a local event
- ★ Volunteer with the campaign
- ★ Walk a neighborhood
- ★ Make calls from home
- ★ Host a coffee or meet-and-greet
- ★ Share campaign updates
- ★ Review official contribution information
- ★ Make a plan to vote in 2026

The first step is understanding what is at stake. The next step is helping more voters see the difference.

To learn more, visit the campaign website at markfororegon.com.

Reject the socialist agenda. **Vote for Mark.**

This election is about two different philosophies of government.

One vision depends on a larger government, higher taxes, expanded bureaucracy, and more centralized control.

Mark Norman's vision depends on opportunity, accountability, public safety, educational excellence, economic growth, individual freedom, local problem-solving, and practical leadership.

Oregon does not need socialism. Oregon needs service, solutions, and accountability.

SERVICE • SOLUTIONS • ACCOUNTABILITY

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